

CLEAR CRYSTALS



CLARA M. BEEDE

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CRYSTALS ***

CLEAR CRYSTALS

by

Clara M. Beede

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Dedicated to
OLNEY, RUSSELL Jr., WILLIAM, ELLWOOD,
And All Our Soldier Boys

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by

CLARA M. BEEDE

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-

MOTHER'S PRAYER

For this new day, our Father, we give thee thanks.
Thou hast blessed us with rest for our bodies,
The glories of a new day are upon us, a gift from above.
Let the light from heaven penetrate our souls,
and may this be the best of our lives, we pray.
Remember those less fortunate, dear Father,
May some messenger of thine bring joy to their hearts today.
Forbid we should shirk any duty coming our way,
for we are thy servants and desire to do thy will.
Our Dear Father thou hast blessed us with many dear ones.
I pray thy blessing upon each one, especially our soldier boys
That they may heed thy voice and follow thee
as their great and true leader. Forbid, dear Lord, that any one
of them be lost from the way in his search for the light.
Go before them and let light from above
make their pathway bright. Come into their hearts
and give them the peace that no man can give, neither can
take it away. I humbly ask these favors in Jesus name.

—KAY MCKEE

LET THERE BE PEACE

Let there be peace, let clouds and storm roll past,
And budding groves burst forth in little leaves.
When April showers flush the brooks and eaves;
May gardens grow and wheat go flowing fast.
Let there be peace on earth, that men may cast
Their hatreds far away and gather sheaves
Of golden days in patterns justice weaves;
That sunset hours may glow with love at last,
The atmosphere be filled with faith and light,
No war, nor bombs, no words of discontent.
Let there be peace on every hill and plain,
That men may live and toil with hearts alight,
That each may aid his brother in content.
Let grasses grow and flowers bloom again.

WHAT IS THIS WISDOM

Remaining staunchly there in shriveled earth,
The canna stood serene, refreshed by dew
That silently, each cooling night anew
Spread living gems to sparkle in their mirth.
Beneath, the bulb lay proving well its birth—
A shower passed, the funnel leaves caught true—
The plant awoke with life and beauty too.
And not a drop was wasted of the worth!

The bud refrained from coming into bloom,
As though it waited for the lusty rain,
With low leaves dried and drooping to the ground.
What is this wisdom in all nature's room
That fights to live and grow, and not in vain,
But God, whose strength in all things may be found.

SOLDIER TRAINS

Hear the rumbling of the trains,
Soldier trains.
Ever droning, jarring, roaring on the rails
Through the amber lights of dawn.
Hear them rolling right along
Now acoming and now gone,
Iron wheel follows wheel,
Round the bend of the river going strong.

They are taking our brave soldier boys
To the barracks. Hear the thumping of the drums
How they beat and beat and beat,
In the morning and at night,
Hear the tramping, marching feet,
All in line stepping fine
Hear the praying from the firesides down the street.

Hear the roaring of the trains,
Speeding trains
With the rumbling. Shouting home-boys off to war!
Now they travel to far shores.
See them waving their good-byes,
There's the girl that Joe adores
Waving hand, smiling band!
Hear the laughter from the windows and the doors.

DEAR POSSESSIONS

A loaf of bread with a glass of milk
With a roof that shelters and a restful bed,
A place to wear the faded silk
And a pillow for the aching head;

A kettle that sings while the night wind sighs,
And a cup of tea to drink;
A hearth to sweep and a babe that cries,
With a pile of dishes in the sink.

A home to keep and a man to love,
With a heart that is true and fine.
These precious things sent from heaven above,
Will be prized for yours and for mine.

THE UNBIDDEN TEARS

Glad tears that rush like rivers down the cheek
Like gilding gold of morning's amber light.
O happy hearts, by hearths when wills are meek!
We welcome sun that chased away the night.
The weeping eyes will not acknowledge hate.
When lovers meet forgiven after pain,
Tears cleanse the heart and mind of fire and mote,
And freshen countenance and bleach the stain.
O rain of peace, that washes doubt away,
And casts a burden from the heart and home.
Sad hearts in joy united on this day;
Now buds will bloom again in garden loam.
Glad tears that come unbidden thus and free
Have banished care and brought you back to me.

THE PROMISE OF SPRING

Today resplendent in red, grays and gold,
No wind disturbs the calm of Winter's rest,
But quiet and serene on earth's broad breast
Is shrub and bush and seed in loamy hold;
The buds on elm are waiting to unfold,
Our biddie hen wears crimson on her crest.
This gorgeous day, when children laugh and jest,
And run and dance and not a thought withhold.

For Winter's frost was gone at early noon.
We know that Spring will come on southern breeze;
The grass will green and roses bloom again.
We love the flowers, summer warmth and boon,
O joy of earth, in green and swaying trees,
In buds and bees on this broad prairie plain.

THE DAYS LIVE AGAIN

O hallowed charm of long departed days;
The good and bad blend in a sparkling stream.
If one recalls youth's glad and care free ways;
The distant roar of music is supreme,
When viewing life's almost forgotten trail.
There is a stream that twines its way about
Through shady spots, by broken, rotted rail.
The falling water glitters, and the trout,
Again, like precious memories, flash and dart.
Through bleak and cold, a precipice once crossed
Still fills with pride and pain the aging heart;
For time has now the thorns and rocks embossed,
And thus the long dead past is always bright,
For those whose sun is sinking into night.

ROLLING TRUCKS

Rolling over desert sands
Steady there are dough-boy's hands.
Gliding past the silver sage
Caring naught for fame or wage;
Rolling trucks for Uncle Sam,
In his kit are bread and ham.
Slipping over moon-lit dunes
Humming low the old men's tunes.
Every moment plays the game,
Like an iron in a flame.
Rolling over desert sands,
Steady there are dough-boy's hands.

AT DUSK

A low blue cloud lies stretched beyond the trees,
All quiet so. The chant of birds uplifts,
And through the evening dusk a tremor sifts,
The chill of night creeps close with turning keys,
And darkness soothes each child. The daylight flees,
Though many voices lend their artful gifts,
And mingle with the city's murmured rifts.
While twilight covers all with mysteries,
There is the roll of train or army truck;
A mother calls her three year old within.
The most of us preparing for the night;
Some go their way to labor for their luck,
And others toil that we may rest or spin.
God guards the whole until the morning light.

THE MORNING

The morning freshened with the dew of night,
Was glad with crowing cock and singing bird;
And through the mists came hope and kindly word.
The east aglow with early amber light.
As perking coffee roused the hungry sprite;
Beside the hearth a friendly pussy purred,
And in a crib a blue-eyed baby stirred,
Awakened from sweet slumber of the night.
O dawning! Here with all her usual charm.
Another day to toil for child and friend,
One hour to praise our God, while hatreds ebbed;
To hope and live and succor from all harm
Those weaker ones who know not how to fend,
And cast a beam that lights their way ahead.

O RIVER BANK

I love to loiter by the old oak tree,
Where waters ripple over clean white stones,
And cresses, mint with feathered fern grown high.
In such a place the peaceful thoughts will come;
There is no hurry there where nature plays.
Soft gentle breezes wave the grass and sedge;
White fluffy clouds pass overhead and roll.
Now dreaming, I hear the cricket's gay song.
O river bank you charm me always so.

THERE WILL COME A DAY

There will come a day, sometime,
When a bright light will shine through
The clouds of darkness, sometime.
And the grass will grow anew;
Glad bells will ring at the dawn;
And at noon great horns will blow;
At evening fear will be gone;
The home lights through dusk will glow.
It will be a joyous day!
And the earth will shout with laughter,
When world peace is made, some day.
We can hear the birds thereafter.

LATE AUTUMN

The fragrant autumn winds float painted leaves
Across the plains at sunset's evening hour,
A scarlet rose, a zinnia in the flower
Stand brilliant there beneath the cottage eaves.
The locust hums his song, the spider weaves
His silken web in every shady bower,
Where thunder clouds pile high in tumbled tower;
The farmer's loft is bursting with great sheaves;
And cornstalks bend with heavy golden loads,
For rains have blessed the land the summer long.
Now children trip on winding trails from school;
They swing in rhythmic time along the roads;
A hungry, hearty crowd, suntanned and strong.
This glorious fall day in evening cool.

ALL HAIL RED CROSS

All hail Red Cross! White robes of light, all hail!
On brave and noble brows the symbol shines.
A cry for help is never called in vain,
For these courageous ones go everywhere,
On sea or land, in sun and stormy sky.
They face all dangers—carry succor forth
To save their fellowmen—with speed and skill
The aid goes out to rescue friend and foe.
They know no enemy but heed each call.
A line is thrown to stranded waif or man.
In flood they rush like water down the slope
To bring relief to those who toss in waves.
They care for mothers left to starve, alone.
In pestilence, they labor long to soothe
The fevered brow and ease the gnawing pain
With medicine and shelter, food and clothes.
In war the wound is dressed and duly nursed
With gentle supple hands—with nourishment
For mind and body. Cross of red, all hail!
They serve for us most willingly and well.
Then chide themselves when they have come too late!
Like mothers when their sons have fallen short;
In early dawn and through the night they toil.
O God do bless this noble work of love;
Let's give and further this most worthy cause.
All hail Red Cross! White robes of hope, all hail!

OUR MORNING PRAYER

God our Father give us strength
In these days of selfish strife,
Let us smile amid the pain,
Now to meet the care of life
In the sunshine and in rain.

SOLDIER TO HIS MOTHER

Remembering those happy days of youth—
The earth was filled with gladness then,
And you, dear Mother, taught me love and truth,
Taught me to seek the best in men.

With heart full of faith and noble thought
To bear my load and do good deeds.
And cherish worthy things, the hope not bought,
With visions for the living needs.

You said be honest with my God and soul,
Devoted to my land and home,
And all that men hold dear. In loyalty
Respect and prize the fertile loam.

Today my country calls, she needs her son
To fight the Japs and Hitler too.
No coming back until the job is done.
This is as honest men would do.

IN THE STORM

Hear the gale roaring through the woods!
Trees bend and snap and sway;
They race and break on this dark day.
If I could fashion some sturdy hoods
To hold the storm at bay,
Then trim and straight would all trees stay.
But great trees knotted by winds' moods,
Like men who face their care,
Stand scarred yet stanch and bravely there.

TO US

O petty trifles! Why cling to us so?
Our time in doing small things quite consumed,
And hearts protected like earth worms encased,
Always singing childish songs, sol me do,
And crawling safe in shady vales below,
Like snails advancing, scoff and hurt endured,
Dead there upon the rack, no port secured.
O brother plant, some grains of corn will grow!
The faithful farmer sows live fertile seed.
Be not a grub but rise and stretch hands up
When on the height reach down to troubled friend,
And lift your fellowmen, toil not for greed.
Wash out the grounds and fill the empty cup.
The rose will bloom where rocky pathways wend.

THE FLY AND THE SPIDER

The big black fly was in a sorry plight;
She hung and dangled in a spider's web.
It was too late to make a hurried flight.
The sand is sifting and the tides will ebb.

The spider then drew dose his silken thread,
It was no use to ask the reason why.
He only wished to eat and save his head,
And he must catch his breakfast, or die.

HER GOOD BYE

I love you, Darling, sweetheart mine,
Our troth is pledged, O joy divine!
With apple blossoms in my hair
I hope and breathe a fervent prayer
To keep my trust all down the years,
And love you always through the tears.
O heart of mine, my feet do sing
As down the aisle into the Spring
Of bursting bud and lilac time,
Of budding trees and robin rhyme,
So tenderly, Dear, I love you.
In happiness I go with you
Now in sunshine to follow on
And into dark when you are gone.
Then back again from misty night
And at the dawn in coming light.
At sunup when the Japs are caught
You will come when the battle's fought.
And then glad shouts the whole day long,
With ringing bells 'ten billion strong.

HILLS AND VALLEYS WAKE

My ears have heard the larks at dawn,
Their bright sweet carols sing,
With burst of morning sun
And all the meadows ring.

My eyes have seen the shining gold,
That rimmed a purple cloud,
And sheets of olive green there spread,
While night puts on a shroud.

And in the east a moon that gleamed
With grey blue light and sheen,
On misty, drooping willow trees,
O fair and silent scene.

These are not half the things I see
On lovely nights and brilliant days,
It seems that hills and valleys wake
To make such holidays.

MORNING THANKSGIVING

We thank our God this Autumn day,
As birds are waking in the vale,
For health and strength to walk his way,
Let justice and peace prevail.
And for this food that's waiting here,
Now fill our hearts with faith and love;
And bless our loved ones far and near,
O God, our Father up above.

OFF TO THE WOODS

All nature dons a cool green coat,
Soft breezes blow and white clouds float;
The blue jay screams his piercing note.

The April sun shines fine today,
And all the world is bright and gay.
Small twinkling leaves now dance and play!

The Spring has made a grand debut;
And turned up sod is reddish blue,
Where last year's roses bloomed for you.

And to the woods then let us hie
To gather sorrel for a pie,
And pick some posies from the rye.

O Daughter come, a walk is free,
Lock up the house and bring the key;
For sing we must in joy and glee.

THE HAPPY CAMPERS

Burning brush
In morning hush
While bacon fragrance floats.

Daylight dreams
Along bright streams
With knapsack and light coats.

Wind blown hair,
They march and share
And sing the happy notes.

THE PROMISE

O Glendolyn, the life of my being,
O Darling, the good in your heart!
Bright eyes in the flash of a moment
Grow sad as the time nears to part,
Tears well in the midst of the laughter,
Unbidden as the showers in Spring.
Although the days cloud, but after
The future will brighten and sing.

O Glendolyn, weep not at my going,
The weary long hours will pass;
And dawn with its flame and a promise
Will touch the grey sod and dry grass.
The elm in the garden will flower
And the hills on the plains be shining.
That day, then the battle is over,
I will come with swift feet, my Darling.

IN REFLECTION

In the morning of my youth
When my veins were full of strength
There was Dad and Mom to say
What to do. They spoke at length.

Did I listen to the truth?
Much of it has passed me by.
Now if only some one would
Speak to me and tell me why.

MEN MUST TOIL

We wakened in the morning
The wind had blown up cold;
And too, the oaks were grumbling
Like men agrowing old.

We must all work this morning,
Though rough and harsh outside,
Men labor in the storming
For all must eat betide.

THAT CLOSE DRAWN VEIL

If we could lift that close drawn veil and see,
The anxious hours might pass in rest and sleep.
But wait! Could men but sow and counting reap?
Who would toil on when knowing loss must be?
No wild glad hoping with expectancy!
And wooing lover then might he not weep?
The fortune which would grieve—no shop to keep.
Enough. Man can climb higher and be free.
Leave be the veil and let men struggle through.
Let roots strike down and seek the growing needs;
And living stock stretch up toward the sun
With life and hope. Then let men work and woo,
Not anchorless, nor tumbling drift as weeds.
Fulfilment in the end and laurel won.

OUR MORNING LESSON

Love our neighbors as ourselves,
May we fit in where we can,
Love our God and praise his name
Is God's law for mortal man.

WHEN THE BOYS COME HOME

Bright smiles and many tear drops
Are begging loved ones stay;
For not all soldier boys come home
When bugles call today.

Brave lassies wait, toiling, hoping,
And keep the hearth brushed clean,
The home fires glowing brightly
With all about serene.

The heart grows weary often,
For hours and days are long.
But when the fight is over
The land will ring with song.

With all the maidens singing
The full and happy notes,
While men go shouting, marching,
At sight of khaki coats.

And Main Street pushing, crowding,
Will be a surging stream,
For when this war is over
Our joy will be supreme.

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CRYSTALS ***

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